FAIRNESS, NOT EQUITY

November 3

2026 general election

San Ramon 94582, Contra Costa County, no party preference. A scored guide under the fairness-not-equity framework. It is not a prediction and not an instruction to vote.

Last verified October 14, 2026 | Polls 7 a.m.–8 p.m. | Register by October 19

Cheat sheet

Every contest in ballot order. Candidate picks use the framework weights and can change when you move the sliders. Measures do not.

STATE OFFICES

01	Governor	Hilton	MEDIUM
02	Lieutenant governor	Romero	MEDIUM
03	Secretary of state	Wagner	MEDIUM
04	Controller	Morgan	MEDIUM
05	Treasurer	Hawks	LOW

06	Attorney general	Bonta	MEDIUM
07	Insurance commissioner	Allen	MEDIUM
08	Board of Equalization, District 2	Pimentel	MEDIUM

YOUR DISTRICTS

09	U.S. House, District 10	Frese	MEDIUM

State Senate District 9. Not on this ballot. The certified list's Senate contests are the even-numbered districts. District 9 is next in 2028. This guide follows the certified list.

10	State Assembly, District 16	Bauer-Kahan	MEDIUM
11	Superintendent of public instruction	Shaw	MEDIUM

COURTS, CITY, AND SCHOOLS

12	Judicial retention	No pick	NO PICK
13	San Ramon mayor	No pick	NO PICK
14	San Ramon City Council, District 2	No pick	NO PICK
15	San Ramon City Council, District 4	No pick	NO PICK

16	San Ramon Valley Unified, Trustee Area 5	No pick	NO PICK
17	Dublin San Ramon Services District, Division 2	No pick	NO PICK

MEASURES

18	Proposition 1	No	MEDIUM
19	Proposition 2	Yes	MEDIUM
20	Proposition 3	No	MEDIUM
21	Proposition 4	No	MEDIUM
22	Proposition 5	Yes	LOW
23	Proposition 37	Yes	LOW
24	Proposition 38	No	MEDIUM
25	Proposition 39	Yes	MEDIUM
26	Proposition 40	No	MEDIUM

27	Proposition 41	Yes	HIGH
28	Proposition 42	Yes	HIGH
29	Proposition 43	Yes	MEDIUM
30	Proposition 44	Yes	LOW
31	Proposition 45	Yes	MEDIUM
32	Measure RTM	No	MEDIUM

UNVERIFIED LOCAL ITEMS

Check your sample ballot

ZIP 94582 is not one council district, one school trustee area, or one services-district division. Mayor is citywide. Everything else in this section depends on the street address. No confidence label belongs on a contest this guide did not score.

On the ballot only if the address matches

- **City Council.** District 2 is Chirag Kathrani against Richard J. Adler. District 4 is Jeffrey Joh against Marisol Rubio. Districts 1 and 3 are not up. Use the city district lookup.
- **San Ramon Valley Unified.** Areas 1, 4, and 5 are this cycle. Patch describes Area 5, the only contest, as eastern and southeastern San Ramon centered on Dougherty Valley: Rachel Hurd against Joel Woods. Area 1 is Amanda Butland, unopposed. Area 4 is Susanna Ordway, unopposed. Many 94582 addresses are not in Area 5. Trustee-area map.
- **Dublin San Ramon Services District, Division 2.** Kismat Kathrani against Donald Downey, if the address is in that division. This guide did not confirm it.

- **A San Ramon city measure.** None turned up in the county measure list as reviewed. Confirm anyway. The absence is not a certified “none exist.”
- **June county fiscal runoffs.** Assessor, auditor-controller, clerk-recorder, treasurer-tax collector, and county superintendent of schools were not on the November contest list reviewed here. If a primary produced no majority, the sample ballot will show it. The June canvass was not re-read.

Not on this ballot

- State Senate District 9. Next regular election is 2028.
- Supervisorial District 2.
- District attorney and sheriff. Next on the 2028 presidential primary under the county’s own candidate guide.

Judicial retention is also unscored. That is because the opinions were not read, not because the seat depends on your street. See the judicial card.

Your weights

The framework defaults sum to 100. Move any slider. The others scale so the seven still sum to 100. Candidate composites, the leader, and the confidence badge update immediately.

Sum	**100**

CHANGED FROM DEFAULT

Now 45 / 15 / 12 / 10 / 8 / 7 / 3

Policy alignment	**45**
Five-year effects	**15**
Concentrated benefit	**12**
Individualism	**10**
Delivery	**8**
Feasibility	**7**
Competence	**3**

A gap under 5 is Low. A gap of 2 or less becomes No pick. A gap of 15 or more stays Medium on these candidate races, because the sources are campaign plans and news reports rather than statutes or case files.

Measures use the framework’s measure tests and stay put. High on a measure means three tests point the same way and none of similar weight points the other way.

The ballot

One card per contest. Open a card for the seven scores, the arithmetic, the sensitivity check, and the links.

STATE OFFICES

GOVERNOR

Xavier Becerra (Democratic, Voting Rights Attorney) and Steve Hilton (Republican, Small Business Owner).

Hilton

over Becerra MEDIUM

Becerra	42.15
Hilton	62.45

Why Hilton over Becerra. Hilton’s published plan would cut income and gas taxes, cut fees on smaller homes, and limit lawsuits that stop construction. Becerra would freeze utility and insurance rates and has not ruled out new taxes. The gap is wide and no default weight shift flips it, and the label stays Medium because these are reported campaign plans, not laws either man has passed.

CANDIDATE SCORES · THESE WEIGHTS

Score breakdown and sources ▲

HOW THE CELLS WERE SET

Policy is 75 against 40 from that tax and rate-freeze contrast. Hilton’s preference for suburban houses over apartments holds five-year effects at 60 rather than higher. Delivery is 30 for both: the sources do not show a checked result this framework would count, and years in office are not delivery. Feasibility is 20 against 70 from the Democratic trifecta since 2011 and the current legislative counts. That gap is weighted at 7 percent. Competence is 60 against 85 from the advisory record and the offices actually held, weighted at 3 percent.

POINTS AT YOUR WEIGHTS

Policy alignment	**45**
Becerra **40** · **18.00**	Hilton **75** · **33.75**
Five-year effects	**15**
Becerra **40** · **6.00**	Hilton **60** · **9.00**
Concentrated benefit	**12**
Becerra **40** · **4.80**	Hilton **55** · **6.60**
Individualism	**10**
Becerra **35** · **3.50**	Hilton **75** · **7.50**
Delivery	**8**
Becerra **30** · **2.40**	Hilton **30** · **2.40**
Feasibility	**7**
Becerra **70** · **4.90**	Hilton **20** · **1.40**
Competence	**3**
Becerra **85** · **2.55**	Hilton **60** · **1.80**

ARITHMETIC

```
Becerra: 18.00 + 6.00 + 4.80 + 3.50 + 2.40 + 4.90 + 2.55 = 42.15
```

```
Hilton: 33.75 + 9.00 + 6.60 + 7.50 + 2.40 + 1.40 + 1.80 = 62.45
```

Gap under these weights: **20.30**. Candidate races in this guide are not marked High. The evidence is campaign summaries and news reports, not statutes or case files.

DEFAULT-WEIGHT SENSITIVITY

0 of 14 default-weight shifts change the leader. The narrowest is feasibility at +10: Hilton 58.59, Becerra 44.68, gap 13.91.

SOURCES

- CalMatters governor guide
- Ballotpedia governor election
- Certified candidate list

LIEUTENANT GOVERNOR

Fiona Ma (Democratic, State Treasurer/CPA) and Gloria Romero (Republican, Educator/Businesswoman).

Romero

over Ma MEDIUM

Ma	43.35
Romero	58.00

Why Romero over Ma. The sourced difference is school choice, which this framework treats as a signature education pick. Fiona Ma's listed backers are the California Labor Federation, the building trades, and AFSCME, and the CalMatters guide did not report a reform platform. The gap is 14.65 and no default weight shift flips it.

CANDIDATE SCORES · THESE WEIGHTS

Score breakdown and sources ▲

HOW THE CELLS WERE SET

Policy is 65 against 40 because school choice is the only clear platform contrast in the source, not a full education plan. Concentrated benefit is 55 against 30 from those labor endorsements on Ma's side and the absence of a comparable organized-interest list for Romero beyond the state Republican Party and Reform California. Delivery stays near the middle: holding the treasurer's office is not itself a framework-aligned result. Feasibility is 25 against 70.

POINTS AT YOUR WEIGHTS

Policy alignment		**45**
Ma **40** · **18.00**	Romero **65** · **29.25**	
Five-year effects		**15**
Ma **45** · **6.75**	Romero **60** · **9.00**	
Concentrated benefit		**12**
Ma **30** · **3.60**	Romero **55** · **6.60**	
Individualism		**10**
Ma **45** · **4.50**	Romero **65** · **6.50**	
Delivery		**8**
Ma **40** · **3.20**	Romero **35** · **2.80**	
Feasibility		**7**

Ma **70** · **4.90** Romero **25** · **1.75**

Competence **3**

Ma **80** · **2.40** Romero **70** · **2.10**

ARITHMETIC

```
Ma: 18.00 + 6.75 + 3.60 + 4.50 + 3.20 + 4.90 + 2.40 = 43.35

Romero: 29.25 + 9.00 + 6.60 + 6.50 + 2.80 + 1.75 + 2.10 = 58.00
```

Gap under these weights: **14.65**. Candidate races in this guide are not marked High. The evidence is campaign summaries and news reports, not statutes or case files.

DEFAULT-WEIGHT SENSITIVITY

0 of 14 default-weight shifts change the leader. The narrowest is feasibility at +10: Romero 55.00, Ma 45.77, gap 9.23.

SOURCES

- CalMatters lieutenant governor guide
- Certified candidate list

SECRETARY OF STATE

Shirley N. Weber (Democratic, California Secretary of State) and Donald P. Wagner (Republican, Orange County Supervisor).

Wagner

over Weber **MEDIUM**

Weber 49.00

Wagner 57.35

Why Wagner over Weber. Wagner supports a voter-identification rule, the same equal-rule idea as a Yes on Proposition 39. Weber’s record is universal mail voting and wider access, which this pass did not score as a framework failure. Raising feasibility narrows the gap to about 3.5 points and does not flip it.

CANDIDATE SCORES · THESE WEIGHTS

Score breakdown and sources ▲

HOW THE CELLS WERE SET

Policy is 65 against 45. One identification rule for every voter is the match. Universal mail voting is not treated as a failure of the framework. Concentrated benefit stays near the middle because donor tables did not render dollar amounts. Delivery is 30 against 40: administering mail voting is the job, not a counted framework result. Feasibility is 30 against 75.

POINTS AT YOUR WEIGHTS

Policy alignment		**45**
Weber **45** · **20.25**		Wagner **65** · **29.25**
Five-year effects		**15**
Weber **50** · **7.50**		Wagner **60** · **9.00**
Concentrated benefit		**12**
Weber **45** · **5.40**		Wagner **50** · **6.00**
Individualism		**10**
Weber **50** · **5.00**		Wagner **65** · **6.50**
Delivery		**8**
Weber **40** · **3.20**		Wagner **30** · **2.40**
Feasibility		**7**
Weber **75** · **5.25**		Wagner **30** · **2.10**
Competence		**3**
Weber **80** · **2.40**		Wagner **70** · **2.10**

ARITHMETIC

```
Weber: 20.25 + 7.50 + 5.40 + 5.00 + 3.20 + 5.25 + 2.40 = 49.00

Wagner: 29.25 + 9.00 + 6.00 + 6.50 + 2.40 + 2.10 + 2.10 = 57.35
```

Gap under these weights: **8.35**. Candidate races in this guide are not marked High. The evidence is campaign summaries and news reports, not statutes or case files.

DEFAULT-WEIGHT SENSITIVITY

0 of 14 default-weight shifts change the leader. The narrowest is feasibility at +10: Wagner 54.86, Weber 51.36, gap 3.50.

SOURCES

- CalMatters secretary of state guide
- Certified candidate list

CONTROLLER

Malia M. Cohen (Democratic, State Controller) and Herb W. Morgan (Republican, Chief Investment Officer).

Morgan

over Cohen MEDIUM

Cohen	51.65
Morgan	60.25

Why Morgan over Cohen. Morgan is running to expose fraud and founded an investment firm later acquired by Cantor Fitzgerald Investment Advisors, which matches this framework's preference for private-sector financial experience in this office. Cohen urges spending caution and has not published a comparable audit plan in the sources used here. The gap is 8.60 and no shift flips it.

CANDIDATE SCORES · THESE WEIGHTS

Score breakdown and sources ▲

HOW THE CELLS WERE SET

Policy is 70 against 50 from that audit-and-experience contrast, not from a claim that fraud has already been documented. Delivery is 30 against 40 because the caution Cohen urged in a budget season is not a completed audit this framework can count. Feasibility is 25 against 70. Competence is 75 against 80: both can read a balance sheet, and the weight is 3 percent.

POINTS AT YOUR WEIGHTS

Policy alignment	Cohen **50** · **22.50**	Morgan **70** · **31.50**
Five-year effects	Cohen **55** · **8.25**	Morgan **65** · **9.75**
Concentrated benefit	Cohen **45** · **5.40**	Morgan **55** · **6.60**

Individualism		**10**
Cohen **50** · **5.00**		Morgan **60** · **6.00**
Delivery		**8**
Cohen **40** · **3.20**		Morgan **30** · **2.40**
Feasibility		**7**
Cohen **70** · **4.90**		Morgan **25** · **1.75**
Competence		**3**
Cohen **80** · **2.40**		Morgan **75** · **2.25**

ARITHMETIC

```
Cohen: 22.50 + 8.25 + 5.40 + 5.00 + 3.20 + 4.90 + 2.40 = 51.65

Morgan: 31.50 + 9.75 + 6.60 + 6.00 + 2.40 + 1.75 + 2.25 = 60.25
```

Gap under these weights: **8.60**. Candidate races in this guide are not marked High. The evidence is campaign summaries and news reports, not statutes or case files.

DEFAULT-WEIGHT SENSITIVITY

0 of 14 default-weight shifts change the leader. The narrowest is feasibility at +10: Morgan 57.05, Cohen 53.32, gap 3.73.

SOURCES

- CalMatters controller guide
- Certified candidate list

TREASURER

Eleni Kounalakis (Democratic, Lieutenant Governor) and Jennifer Hawks (Republican, Retired Business Executive).

Hawks

over Kounalakis LOW

Kounalakis	47.40
Hawks	**51.25**

Why Hawks over Kounalakis. Hawks argues she would be an independent check, without a sourced plan for the state's investments or debt. Kounalakis's sourced record is votes against University of California and California State University tuition hikes, plus a long Democratic fundraising career. The gap is 3.85, so this is Low, and I am not confident here.

What would settle it. A sourced Hawks plan for the state's investments and debt, and Kounalakis's record on the state's bond programs, would settle it.

CANDIDATE SCORES · THESE WEIGHTS

Score breakdown and sources ▲

HOW THE CELLS WERE SET

Policy stays near the middle, 55 against 45, because independence is a real point and a missing investment plan is not a high score. Concentrated benefit is 60 against 35 from the fundraising career on one side and the lack of a party-institution endorsement list on the other. Feasibility is 25 against 70, which is why one shift flips the race. Do not treat a 3.85-point lead as a settled preference.

POINTS AT YOUR WEIGHTS

Policy alignment	**45**	
Kounalakis **45** · **20.25**	Hawks **55** · **24.75**	
Five-year effects	**15**	
Kounalakis **50** · **7.50**	Hawks **55** · **8.25**	
Concentrated benefit	**12**	
Kounalakis **35** · **4.20**	Hawks **60** · **7.20**	
Individualism	**10**	
Kounalakis **55** · **5.50**	Hawks **55** · **5.50**	
Delivery	**8**	
Kounalakis **35** · **2.80**	Hawks **25** · **2.00**	
Feasibility	**7**	
Kounalakis **70** · **4.90**	Hawks **25** · **1.75**	
Competence	**3**	
Kounalakis **75** · **2.25**	Hawks **60** · **1.80**	

ARITHMETIC

```
Kounalakis: 20.25 + 7.50 + 4.20 + 5.50 + 2.80 + 4.90 + 2.25 = 47.40
```

Hawks: 24.75 + 8.25 + 7.20 + 5.50 + 2.00 + 1.75 + 1.80 = 51.25

Gap under these weights: **3.85**. Candidate races in this guide are not marked High. The evidence is campaign summaries and news reports, not statutes or case files.

DEFAULT-WEIGHT SENSITIVITY

1 of 14 default-weight shifts flips the leader. Feasibility at +10: Kounalakis 49.45, Hawks 48.86, gap 0.59 the other way. Among shifts that keep Hawks first, the narrowest is concentrated benefit at −10: Hawks 50.28, Kounalakis 48.78, gap 1.50.

SOURCES

- CalMatters treasurer guide
- Certified candidate list

ATTORNEY GENERAL

Rob Bonta (Democratic, California Attorney General) and Michael E. Gates (Republican, Deputy United States Attorney).

Bonta

over Gates MEDIUM

Bonta	62.65
Gates	43.15

Why Bonta over Gates. Bonta’s term has been spent enforcing laws that require cities to allow new housing, while Gates fought those laws as Huntington Beach city attorney. Gates’s equal-enforcement statement still fits this framework, and it does not outweigh that housing record. The label stays Medium because the sources are CalMatters and the candidates’ own statements, not the case files.

CANDIDATE SCORES · THESE WEIGHTS

Score breakdown and sources ▲

HOW THE CELLS WERE SET

Policy is 70 against 40 from that housing-enforcement contrast. Individualism is 50 against 60 because Gates’s voter-guide statement says equal justice without regard to zip code or last name. Concentrated benefit is 35 against 50: Bonta’s listed endorsements include the Democratic Party, the California

Teachers Association, and California Environmental Voters. Delivery is 55 against 35 for described official conduct, not an audited unit count. His questionnaire claim of a pathway for 40,000 units, and Gates's claim of a double-digit crime drop, were not checked against a non-campaign record. Feasibility is 75 against 30. CalMatters also reports Gates left a 2025 Justice Department post in November 2025 and returned to the Huntington Beach city attorney's office. The certified designation remains Deputy United States Attorney.

POINTS AT YOUR WEIGHTS

Policy alignment		**45**
Bonta **70** · **31.50**	Gates **40** · **18.00**	
Five-year effects		**15**
Bonta **65** · **9.75**	Gates **40** · **6.00**	
Concentrated benefit		**12**
Bonta **35** · **4.20**	Gates **50** · **6.00**	
Individualism		**10**
Bonta **50** · **5.00**	Gates **60** · **6.00**	
Delivery		**8**
Bonta **55** · **4.40**	Gates **35** · **2.80**	
Feasibility		**7**
Bonta **75** · **5.25**	Gates **30** · **2.10**	
Competence		**3**
Bonta **85** · **2.55**	Gates **75** · **2.25**	

ARITHMETIC

```
Bonta: 31.50 + 9.75 + 4.20 + 5.00 + 4.40 + 5.25 + 2.55 = 62.65
```

```
Gates: 18.00 + 6.00 + 6.00 + 6.00 + 2.80 + 2.10 + 2.25 = 43.15
```

Gap under these weights: **19.50**. Candidate races in this guide are not marked High. The evidence is campaign summaries and news reports, not statutes or case files.

DEFAULT-WEIGHT SENSITIVITY

0 of 14 default-weight shifts change the leader. The narrowest is concentrated benefit at +10: Bonta 60.14, Gates 43.77, gap 16.36.

SOURCES

- CalMatters attorney general guide

- Official voter-guide statements
- Bonta’s GrowSF questionnaire
- Ballotpedia attorney general election

INSURANCE COMMISSIONER

Ben Allen (Democratic, California State Senator) and Jane Kim (Democratic, Attorney/Consumer Advocate). Same-party runoff.

Allen

over Kim MEDIUM

Allen	48.00
Kim	37.55

Why Allen over Kim. Kim proposes a state-run disaster insurer funded by insurer premiums, and a larger public auto program. Allen wants more enforcement staff and a wildfire-resilience loan program inside a market that still uses private carriers. Neither has run an insurance business, and the gap is 10.45 with no flip.

CANDIDATE SCORES · THESE WEIGHTS

Score breakdown and sources ▲

HOW THE CELLS WERE SET

Policy is 48 against 35. A new public insurer is a new obligation this framework treats skeptically. Allen’s plan is not a market-opening reform, which is why 48 is only a step above the middle. The framework’s usual preference for industry operating experience does not pick either candidate. Feasibility is 65 against 60. Both are Democrats on the certified list.

POINTS AT YOUR WEIGHTS

Policy alignment		**45**
Allen **48** · **21.60**		Kim **35** · **15.75**
Five-year effects		**15**
Allen **45** · **6.75**		Kim **35** · **5.25**
Concentrated benefit		**12**

Allen **40** · **4.80**	Kim **30** · **3.60**
Individualism	**10**
Allen **50** · **5.00**	Kim **40** · **4.00**
Delivery	**8**
Allen **40** · **3.20**	Kim **35** · **2.80**
Feasibility	**7**
Allen **65** · **4.55**	Kim **60** · **4.20**
Competence	**3**
Allen **70** · **2.10**	Kim **65** · **1.95**

ARITHMETIC

```
Allen: 21.60 + 6.75 + 4.80 + 5.00 + 3.20 + 4.55 + 2.10 = 48.00

Kim: 15.75 + 5.25 + 3.60 + 4.00 + 2.80 + 4.20 + 1.95 = 37.55
```

Gap under these weights: **10.45**. Candidate races in this guide are not marked High. The evidence is campaign summaries and news reports, not statutes or case files.

DEFAULT-WEIGHT SENSITIVITY

0 of 14 default-weight shifts change the leader. Three shifts tie for the narrowest gap, about 9.95, and none changes the leader.

SOURCES

- CalMatters insurance commissioner guide
- Certified candidate list

BOARD OF EQUALIZATION, DISTRICT 2

Sally J. Lieber (Democratic, incumbent) and John Pimentel (Democratic, San Mateo County Community College District trustee).

Pimentel

over Lieber **MEDIUM**

Lieber	45.85
Pimentel	**62.30**

Why Pimentel over Lieber. Pimentel says he would end the sales tax on food, a regressive tax this framework disfavors. Lieber's listed endorsements include the Democratic Party, SEIU California, and the California Teachers Association. The gap clears 15 and does not flip, and the label stays Medium because both platforms are campaign material rather than a statute either candidate has passed in this office.

CANDIDATE SCORES · THESE WEIGHTS

Score breakdown and sources ▲

HOW THE CELLS WERE SET

Policy is 70 against 45 from the food-tax proposal reported by the San Luis Obispo Tribune. Concentrated benefit is 60 against 30 from the endorsement contrast. CalMatters also lists the Howard Jarvis Taxpayers Association for Pimentel. The Tribune's April 2026 reading said both campaigns were mostly self-funded then. Those figures are not treated as the latest general-election totals. Delivery is 30 against 40. Do not read this pick as a claim that Pimentel would abolish the board. That sentence is not in the sources used here.

POINTS AT YOUR WEIGHTS

Policy alignment	Lieber **45** · **20.25**	Pimentel **70** · **31.50**
Five-year effects	Lieber **50** · **7.50**	Pimentel **65** · **9.75**
Concentrated benefit	Lieber **30** · **3.60**	Pimentel **60** · **7.20**
Individualism	Lieber **45** · **4.50**	Pimentel **60** · **6.00**
Delivery	Lieber **40** · **3.20**	Pimentel **30** · **2.40**
Feasibility	Lieber **65** · **4.55**	Pimentel **50** · **3.50**
Competence	Lieber **75** · **2.25**	Pimentel **65** · **1.95**

ARITHMETIC

```
Lieber: 20.25 + 7.50 + 3.60 + 4.50 + 3.20 + 4.55 + 2.25 = 45.85
```

```
Pimentel: 31.50 + 9.75 + 7.20 + 6.00 + 2.40 + 3.50 + 1.95 = 62.30
```

Gap under these weights: **16.45**. Candidate races in this guide are not marked High. The evidence is campaign summaries and news reports, not statutes or case files.

DEFAULT-WEIGHT SENSITIVITY

0 of 14 default-weight shifts change the leader. The narrowest is feasibility at +10: Pimentel 61.18, Lieber 47.59, gap 13.59.

SOURCES

- CalMatters Board of Equalization guide
- San Luis Obispo Tribune voter guide
- Certified candidate list

YOUR DISTRICTS

U.S. HOUSE, DISTRICT 10

Mark DeSaulnier (Democratic, United States Congressman) and Jeff Frese (Republican, Small Business Owner).

Frese

over DeSaulnier **MEDIUM**

DeSaulnier	43.00
Frese	55.60

Why Frese over DeSaulnier. Frese would cut deficit spending, limit congressional terms, and reduce red tape on building. DeSaulnier's campaign stresses workers' rights, health-care access, and a progressive frame, with family tax cuts pointing the other way. The gap is 12.60 and no default weight shift flips it.

CANDIDATE SCORES · THESE WEIGHTS

Score breakdown and sources ▲

HOW THE CELLS WERE SET

Policy is 65 against 40. Frese's homebuyer ban on hedge funds points away from the framework, so 65 is not the top of the band. DeSaulnier's policy cell moved from 45 to 40 after the local guide made the progressive and worker frame clearer. Concentrated benefit stays near the middle: Ballotpedia listed $567,258 in receipts for DeSaulnier as of June 30, 2026, and listed Frese's receipts as data not available. Missing data is not independence. Delivery is 25 against 35. The $46 million in local projects is a spending claim, not a counted success. This file does not adopt Frese's description of DeSaulnier's bill record.

POINTS AT YOUR WEIGHTS

Policy alignment	DeSaulnier **40** · **18.00**	Frese **65** · **29.25**	**45**
Five-year effects	DeSaulnier **40** · **6.00**	Frese **55** · **8.25**	**15**
Concentrated benefit	DeSaulnier **45** · **5.40**	Frese **50** · **6.00**	**12**
Individualism	DeSaulnier **45** · **4.50**	Frese **60** · **6.00**	**10**
Delivery	DeSaulnier **35** · **2.80**	Frese **25** · **2.00**	**8**
Feasibility	DeSaulnier **60** · **4.20**	Frese **35** · **2.45**	**7**
Competence	DeSaulnier **70** · **2.10**	Frese **55** · **1.65**	**3**

ARITHMETIC

```
DeSaulnier: 18.00 + 6.00 + 5.40 + 4.50 + 2.80 + 4.20 + 2.10 = 43.00

Frese: 29.25 + 8.25 + 6.00 + 6.00 + 2.00 + 2.45 + 1.65 = 55.60
```

Gap under these weights: **12.60**. Candidate races in this guide are not marked High. The evidence is campaign summaries and news reports, not statutes or case files.

DEFAULT-WEIGHT SENSITIVITY

0 of 14 default-weight shifts change the leader. The narrowest is feasibility at +10: Frese 53.73, DeSaulnier 44.55, gap 9.18.

SOURCES

- Ballotpedia District 10
- DeSaulnier Ballotpedia profile
- DeSaulnier campaign site
- San Ramon Patch voter guide

STATE ASSEMBLY, DISTRICT 16

Rebecca Bauer-Kahan (Democratic, Assemblymember) and Joseph A. Rubay (Republican, Businessman/Father).

Bauer-Kahan

over Rubay MEDIUM

Bauer-Kahan 50.70

Rubay 42.50

Why Bauer-Kahan over Rubay. Rubay opposes state policies that push higher-density housing in the suburbs, which fails this framework's supply test. Bauer-Kahan's campaign, as reported locally, stresses online safety, insurance, school funding, and reproductive rights, and does not make that anti-supply argument. The source is a San Ramon Patch guide, thinner than the CalMatters pages used statewide, and the gap is 8.20.

CANDIDATE SCORES · THESE WEIGHTS

Score breakdown and sources ▲

HOW THE CELLS WERE SET

Policy is only 50 against 40. Her lead is not a detailed housing-bill record. Consent-calendar votes were not treated as a platform. Policy alignment, not the incumbency cells, is the larger share of the 8.20-point gap: about 4.5 points from policy and about 3.2 from feasibility. Feasibility is 75 against 30 because she is the incumbent in a Democratic district, and that weight is 7 percent.

POINTS AT YOUR WEIGHTS

Policy alignment **45**

Bauer-Kahan **50** · **22.50** Rubay **40** · **18.00**

Five-year effects **15**

Bauer-Kahan **50** · **7.50**	Rubay **40** · **6.00**
Concentrated benefit	**12**
Bauer-Kahan **45** · **5.40**	Rubay **55** · **6.60**
Individualism	**10**
Bauer-Kahan **50** · **5.00**	Rubay **60** · **6.00**
Delivery	**8**
Bauer-Kahan **35** · **2.80**	Rubay **25** · **2.00**
Feasibility	**7**
Bauer-Kahan **75** · **5.25**	Rubay **30** · **2.10**
Competence	**3**
Bauer-Kahan **75** · **2.25**	Rubay **60** · **1.80**

ARITHMETIC

```
Bauer-Kahan: 22.50 + 7.50 + 5.40 + 5.00 + 2.80 + 5.25 + 2.25 = 50.70
```

```
Rubay: 18.00 + 6.00 + 6.60 + 6.00 + 2.00 + 2.10 + 1.80 = 42.50
```

Gap under these weights: **8.20**. Candidate races in this guide are not marked High. The evidence is campaign summaries and news reports, not statutes or case files.

DEFAULT-WEIGHT SENSITIVITY

0 of 14 default-weight shifts change the leader. The narrowest is feasibility at −10, clipped to 0: Bauer-Kahan 48.87, Rubay 43.44, gap 5.43.

SOURCES

- San Ramon Patch voter guide
- Certified candidate list

SUPERINTENDENT OF PUBLIC INSTRUCTION

Richard Barrera (State Superintendent Advisor) and Sonja Shaw (School District President). Nonpartisan. The office loses department control in 2027 to a governor-appointed education commissioner and keeps a statewide platform.

Shaw

over Barrera **MEDIUM**

Barrera 42.35

Shaw 56.90

Why Shaw over Barrera. Shaw’s stated focus is a return to academic basics. Barrera’s priority is more school funding and an easier path into teaching, and the California Teachers Association endorsement is what made him known outside San Diego in the CalMatters account. The gap is 14.55 and no shift flips it.

CANDIDATE SCORES · THESE WEIGHTS

Score breakdown and sources ▲

HOW THE CELLS WERE SET

Policy is 60 against 40. The transgender-student fight is part of Shaw’s public record and is not the whole score. Academic basics against a union-backed funding agenda is the core. Concentrated benefit is 55 against 30 because of that California Teachers Association endorsement. Delivery is 40 for both: a school-board presidency is not, by itself, a statewide result.

POINTS AT YOUR WEIGHTS

Policy alignment	Barrera **40** · **18.00**	Shaw **60** · **27.00** — **45**
Five-year effects	Barrera **45** · **6.75**	Shaw **60** · **9.00** — **15**
Concentrated benefit	Barrera **30** · **3.60**	Shaw **55** · **6.60** — **12**
Individualism	Barrera **45** · **4.50**	Shaw **60** · **6.00** — **10**
Delivery	Barrera **40** · **3.20**	Shaw **40** · **3.20** — **8**
Feasibility	Barrera **60** · **4.20**	Shaw **45** · **3.15** — **7**
Competence	Barrera **70** · **2.10**	Shaw **65** · **1.95** — **3**

ARITHMETIC

Barrera: 18.00 + 6.75 + 3.60 + 4.50 + 3.20 + 4.20 + 2.10 = 42.35

Shaw: 27.00 + 9.00 + 6.60 + 6.00 + 3.20 + 3.15 + 1.95 = 56.90

Gap under these weights: **14.55**. Candidate races in this guide are not marked High. The evidence is campaign summaries and news reports, not statutes or case files.

DEFAULT-WEIGHT SENSITIVITY

0 of 14 default-weight shifts change the leader. The narrowest is feasibility at +10: Shaw 55.82, Barrera 43.95, gap 11.86.

SOURCES

- CalMatters superintendent guide
- Certified candidate list

COURTS, CITY, AND SCHOOLS

JUDICIAL RETENTION

Supreme Court: Kelli M. Evans and Joshua Groban. First Appellate District: Charles A. Smiley, Kathleen M. Banke, and Monique Langhorne Wilson (Division One); Presiding Justice Therese M. Stewart and Tara M. Desautels (Division Two); Ioana Petrou and Victor A. Rodriguez (Division Three); Presiding Justice Tracie L. Brown (Division Four); Mark Simons, Danny Y. Chou, and Gordon Burns (Division Five).

No pick

NO PICK

No pick. The opinions, discipline records, and the official voter-guide judicial evaluations were not read. Abstain is not a yes and not a no.

What would settle it. Read the opinions or the official voter-guide judicial section.

NOT SCORED · SLIDERS DO NOT APPLY

Names and sources ▲

- Certified candidate list

SAN RAMON MAYOR

Citywide. Emma Chigbu (Student), Mark H. Armstrong (Mayor/Retired Colonel), and Paschalis Ntatsos (Nonprofit Director/CEO).

No pick

NO PICK

No pick. Ballot designations, and the fact that a local guide collected answers, are not a scored record. The answer text was not in the page retrieved for this pass.

What would settle it. Those answers, read against the framework, would settle a score. The office itself is on every San Ramon ballot.

NOT SCORED · SLIDERS DO NOT APPLY

Names and sources ▲

- County contest list
- San Ramon Patch voter guide

SAN RAMON CITY COUNCIL, DISTRICT 2

Chirag Kathrani (Founder/Entrepreneur) and Richard J. Adler (Appointed Incumbent). You vote here only if your address is in District 2. Districts 1 and 3 are not on this ballot.

No pick

NO PICK

No pick. The household’s district was not looked up, and the candidates’ answers were not scored from designations.

What would settle it. Confirm the district on the city lookup, then read the candidates’ own answers.

NOT SCORED · SLIDERS DO NOT APPLY

Names and sources ▲

- County contest list

- City district lookup
- San Ramon Patch voter guide

SAN RAMON CITY COUNCIL, DISTRICT 4

Jeffrey Joh (Technology Strategist) and Marisol Rubio (Councilwoman/In-Home Provider). You vote here only if your address is in District 4.

No pick

NO PICK

No pick, for the same reason as District 2. A 94582 address is in one council district, not both.

What would settle it. Confirm the district, then read the answers Patch collected. They were not in the guide page used here.

NOT SCORED · SLIDERS DO NOT APPLY

Names and sources ▲

- County contest list
- City district lookup
- San Ramon Patch voter guide

SAN RAMON VALLEY UNIFIED, TRUSTEE AREA 5

Rachel Hurd (incumbent since 2006, seeking a fifth term) and Joel Woods (substitute teacher), if your address is in Area 5. Patch describes Area 5 as eastern and southeastern San Ramon, centered on Dougherty Valley. Area 1 has one candidate, Amanda Butland. Area 4 has one candidate, incumbent Susanna Ordway. ZIP 94582 includes Dougherty Valley and older San Ramon, so many 94582 voters are not in Area 5.

No pick

NO PICK

No pick. Two names, a geography note, and unopposed seats are not a scored record of how either candidate would govern.

What would settle it. Confirm the trustee area on the district map and the sample ballot, then read Hurd's and Woods's answers.

NOT SCORED · SLIDERS DO NOT APPLY

Names and sources ▲

- County contest list
- SRVUSD trustee-area map
- San Ramon Patch voter guide

DUBLIN SAN RAMON SERVICES DISTRICT, DIVISION 2

Kismat Kathrani (Technology Business Owner) and Donald Downey (Registered Geologist), if your address is in Division 2. This pass did not confirm that a 94582 household is in that division.

No pick

NO PICK

No pick. The division was not pinned to the ZIP, and designations are not a record.

What would settle it. The sample ballot is the check. If Division 2 is not on it, you do not have this contest.

NOT SCORED · SLIDERS DO NOT APPLY

Names and sources ▲

- County contest list

Measures

Yes or no under the measure tests. The sliders do not move these.

MEASURES

PROPOSITION 1

No

MEDIUM

Why no. The measure would authorize $11.25 billion in general-obligation bonds, $10 billion for affordable rental and homeownership programs and $1.25 billion for veterans' home, farm, and mobilehome loans. A new long-term debt repaid by taxpayers fails this framework's high bar for new obligations. The housing purpose is a real point the other way, which is why this is Medium rather than High.

MEASURE TEST · NOT THESE WEIGHTS

What it changes, and sources ▲

Legislative statute. Official summaries used here are paraphrases of the Secretary of State's June 29, 2026 numbering release. A local guide's "about 40,000 homes" figure is not treated as the legislative analyst's estimate.

SOURCES

- Numbering release
- Qualified measures

PROPOSITION 2

Yes

MEDIUM

Why yes. The amendment raises the Budget Stabilization Account cap from 10 percent of general-fund tax proceeds to 20 percent, changes the capital-gains set-aside, and lets a May revision function as a budget-emergency proclamation when the constitutional conditions are met. A larger reserve matches the fiscal-discipline test and is not a new tax. The easier path to declaring a budget emergency is the point the other way.

MEASURE TEST · NOT THESE WEIGHTS

What it changes, and sources ▲

Legislative constitutional amendment. The qualified-list title is an increase in the state's rainy-day fund. This pick follows the amendment text in the numbering release, not a shorthand that the state may save "10 percent more."

SOURCES

- Numbering release
- Qualified measures

PROPOSITION 3

No

MEDIUM

Why no. It would make the temporary high-income tax rates, now set to expire in 2031, permanent. The analyst's summary says that keeps about $5 billion to $15 billion a year. A permanent tax fails the high bar. The payers are high-income filers, and the stated split is mostly schools, so this is Medium rather than High.

MEASURE TEST · NOT THESE WEIGHTS

What it changes, and sources ▲

Initiative constitutional amendment. Thresholds in the summary are about $360,000 for single filers, $721,000 for joint filers, and $490,000 for heads of household, in 2024 dollars.

SOURCES

- Numbering release
- Qualified measures

PROPOSITION 4

No

MEDIUM

Why no. It would repeal the ban on spending public money on campaigns for elective office, with exceptions and limits. Taxpayers would fund candidates they oppose. The argument that public funding reduces donor dependence is why this is Medium rather than High.

MEASURE TEST · NOT THESE WEIGHTS

What it changes, and sources ▲

Legislative statute. This pass did not review the campaign's funders.

SOURCES

- Numbering release
- Qualified measures

PROPOSITION 5

Yes

LOW

Why yes. It would drop the successor election when a statewide officer is recalled and fill the office under ordinary vacancy rules. That is a process change. It does not clearly hit the tax test or the liberty test. The lean is Yes because it ends a plurality side-election. I am not confident here.

What would settle it. Whether you want the successor chosen on the same ballot.

MEASURE TEST · NOT THESE WEIGHTS

What it changes, and sources ▲

Legislative constitutional amendment. If the governor is recalled, the lieutenant governor serves the rest of the term, with a special election in the first two years if the recall falls before the next nomination period closes. The recalled officer cannot be appointed to the vacancy.

SOURCES

- Numbering release
- Qualified measures

PROPOSITION 37

Yes

LOW

Why yes. It authorizes up to $25 billion in bonds for down-payment loans of up to 17 percent of the price, for buyers under 200 percent of area median income who put at least 3 percent down. The official summary says borrowers repay the bonds and the analyst estimates no direct state or local cost. That is why this is not treated like Proposition 1. The structure is novel, so the confidence is Low.

What would settle it. Whether repayment depends on a taxpayer backstop the official summary does not show.

MEASURE TEST · NOT THESE WEIGHTS

What it changes, and sources ▲

Initiative statute. Push back if the repayment promise depends on a taxpayer backstop the summary does not show.

SOURCES

- Numbering release
- Qualified measures

PROPOSITION 38

No

MEDIUM

Why no. It would authorize $8.4 billion in general-obligation bonds for immunology research, about $500 million a year for 25 years from the general fund. New long-term debt on diffuse taxpayers fails the high bar. The disease-research purpose and the requirement to sell resulting drugs in California at 20 percent below the national average are the point the other way.

MEASURE TEST · NOT THESE WEIGHTS

What it changes, and sources ▲

Initiative statute. Half the money goes to a University of California-affiliated institute and half to grants.

SOURCES

- Numbering release
- Qualified measures

PROPOSITION 39

Yes

MEDIUM

Why yes. It would require government-issued identification at the polls, or the last four digits of such an identification number on a mail ballot, and require the state to provide identification cards on request. One identification rule for every voter matches this framework's rule-equality test. The cost, and the risk that a lawful voter is turned away, are the point the other way.

MEASURE TEST · NOT THESE WEIGHTS

What it changes, and sources ▲

Initiative constitutional amendment. The analyst's estimate is tens of millions of dollars one time, and ongoing costs from the tens of millions to the low hundreds of millions. This pass did not review evidence about how often a lawful voter is turned away.

SOURCES

- Numbering release
- Qualified measures

PROPOSITION 40

No

MEDIUM

Why no. It would impose a one-time tax of up to 5 percent on covered assets above $1 billion, excluding real property and some retirement accounts, and exempt that revenue from the state spending limit. A new tax plus a spending-limit opt-out fails the fiscal tests. San Ramon Patch describes the initiative as labor-union-sponsored. It stays Medium because the tax is one time and the payers are a narrow class.

MEASURE TEST · NOT THESE WEIGHTS

What it changes, and sources ▲

Initiative constitutional amendment and statute. The analyst's estimate says the tax would raise tens of billions over several years and that income-tax revenue would likely fall afterward. Ninety percent of the revenue is for health care and 10 percent for food assistance or education.

SOURCES

- Numbering release
- Qualified measures
- San Ramon Patch voter guide

PROPOSITION 41

Yes

HIGH

Why yes. It would require audits of programs funded by new statewide special taxes and block new state taxes that opt out of the spending limit, including taxes on the same ballot. It does not create a tax, it blocks those opt-outs, and it requires the audits. No test of similar weight points the other way.

MEASURE TEST · NOT THESE WEIGHTS

What it changes, and sources ▲

Initiative constitutional amendment. The analyst says the net fiscal effect is unknown. That is uncertainty about magnitude, not a test pointing the other way.

SOURCES

- Numbering release

- Qualified measures

PROPOSITION 42

Yes

HIGH

Why yes. It would prohibit a new state tax on personal property, including retirement accounts, financial assets, business interests, and intellectual property, and prohibit certain retroactive state taxes, including measures on the same ballot. The lower future revenue the analyst flags is the intended effect under this framework. Three tests align and none points the other way.

MEASURE TEST · NOT THESE WEIGHTS

What it changes, and sources ▲

Initiative constitutional amendment. The three tests are: no new tax of this kind, no retroactive tax of the kind described, and the rule covers same-ballot measures.

SOURCES

- Numbering release
- Qualified measures

PROPOSITION 43

Yes

MEDIUM

Why yes. Beginning in 2027, a local government, including voters using the initiative, could not impose, extend, or increase a special tax without a two-thirds vote, with stated exceptions. A higher bar for new local taxes matches this framework. The official framing, that the rule would bind voter initiatives and not only governing bodies, is the point the other way.

MEASURE TEST · NOT THESE WEIGHTS

What it changes, and sources ▲

Legislative constitutional amendment. The qualified-list title says it limits voters' ability to raise local revenue.

SOURCES

- Numbering release
- Qualified measures

PROPOSITION 44

Yes

LOW

Why yes. It would require nonprofit federally qualified health centers to spend at least 90 percent of revenue on program services, with penalties the attorney general can define. The accountability direction matches the concentrated-benefit test. Whether 90 percent is a workable line was not established in the official summary. I am not confident here.

What would settle it. Whether 90 percent is a workable line, and how the penalty fund would work.

MEASURE TEST · NOT THESE WEIGHTS

What it changes, and sources ▲

Initiative statute. San Ramon Patch describes the measure as union-backed and says penalties that are not refunded after five years can fund clinic-worker training, recruitment, and retention. The analyst's estimate is state cost up to the low tens of millions a year, much of it covered by fees and penalties.

SOURCES

- Numbering release
- Qualified measures
- San Ramon Patch voter guide

PROPOSITION 45

Yes

MEDIUM

Why yes. It would shorten environmental review and court challenges for specified housing, transportation, water, health, and clean-energy projects. Faster housing review matches the five-year and supply tests. Narrower court review is a rule-of-law point the other way.

MEASURE TEST · NOT THESE WEIGHTS

What it changes, and sources ▲

Initiative statute. The analyst expects implementation costs in the tens of millions a year at first, likely net savings later, and an uncertain court effect.

SOURCES

- Numbering release
- Qualified measures

MEASURE RTM

No

MEDIUM

Why no. It would add a retail sales tax of one-half of one percent in Contra Costa for 14 years, about $980 million a year, to avoid major transit cuts and to fund safety, repairs, and oversight. This framework disfavors new sales taxes, and the ballot question reads as revenue to cover an operating gap. Riders and the named repairs are a real benefit the other way, so this is Medium rather than High.

MEASURE TEST · NOT THESE WEIGHTS

What it changes, and sources ▲

The county counsel’s analysis says the district was created by Senate Bill 63 (2025) and covers Alameda, Contra Costa, San Mateo, Santa Clara, and San Francisco. The San Francisco rate in that analysis is one percent. This pass did not review the yes and no campaign treasuries.

SOURCES

- Contra Costa measure page

Framework: fairness-not-equity, Common-Sense Fairness (Not Equity). Weights at rest: policy alignment 45, five-year effects 15, concentrated benefit 12, individualism 10, delivery of framework-aligned results 8, feasibility 7, competence 3. Feasibility is additive. It is not a multiplier.

Last verified: October 14, 2026. Ballots are mailed by October 5. A mailed ballot must be postmarked by November 3 and received by November 10. Counties target certification by December 3.

Screening is not an accusation. No candidate in the scored races had a sourced pattern that failed the character gate in this pass. Absence of a note is not a certification of character.

Source repository: charbel-design/ca-ballot-analysis.